

THE INTELLIGENT HOMEOWNER'S DECISION FRAMEWORK

How to Choose Hardwood That Performs,
Appreciates, and Never Becomes a Liability

Hardwood, Done Once. Done Right.

ecowoods.ca | Est. 1998 / 2000 | 5,200+ Homes | Lifetime Workmanship Warranty

Decision Architecture

- 1 Hardwood as the highest-ROI renovation in the GTA
- 2 2026 installed economics (realistic ranges)
- 3 Species hierarchy — Janka, aesthetics, resale signalling
- 4 Solid versus engineered decision tree
- 5 What fixed price actually protects
- 6 Zero dust, salaried artisans, lifetime warranty
- 7 How to evaluate any installer (checklist)
- 8 The EcoWoods standard versus the market average

Hardwood — Highest-ROI Renovation in Toronto

- 70–100%+ cost recovery on resale in the GTA
- Strongest visual and emotional signal to buyers
- Removes the #1 buyer fear: future change orders and failure
- Fixed-price installation eliminates classic renovation risk

Reality

A correctly specified and installed hardwood floor is one of the few renovations that reliably returns more than it costs — when the physics and the process are both mastered.



Fully Installed Pricing (GTA)

- Average fully installed: $\approx$ \$13 / sq ft
- Typical range: \$8 – \$18 / sq ft
- Screen & Recoat: \$2.50 – \$4.00 / sq ft
- Full Sand & Finish: \$4.75 – \$7.50 / sq ft
- Premium new install (wide-plank, oil finishes, stairs): \$11 – \$18 / sq ft

These numbers assume professional installation, correct product, and the full protocol. Bargain pricing almost always means skipped moisture testing, shorter acclimation, or subcontractors.

Species Hierarchy — Janka Scale & GTA Preference

Species	Janka	Role in the GTA
White Oak / European Oak	≈1360	Current aesthetic & resale sovereign
Hard Maple	1450	High-traffic workhorse
Red Oak (Northern)	≈1290	Traditional default
Hickory	1820	Extreme durability
Black Walnut	1010	Luxury accent

Wide-plank European white oak currently dominates both aesthetics and resale signalling across the Greater Toronto Area.

Hardness is only one variable — stability, grain character, and finish performance matter equally.

Solid vs Engineered — Decision Tree

- ❶ Is the substrate plywood over joists? → Solid is possible
- ❷ Is the substrate concrete, condo slab, or radiant? → Engineered is required
- ❸ Is the home subject to large seasonal RH swings? → Engineered preferred
- ❹ Does the client want maximum future refinishing cycles? → Solid (only if substrate allows)

EcoWoods Rule

We specify. We never sell what the house cannot support for decades.

The correct product is the one that will still look and perform correctly in 2046.

What Fixed Price Actually Protects

- The number written on the estimate is the number that will be paid
- No change orders for “unforeseen conditions” that should have been tested on day one
- Removes the classic renovation anxiety that destroys buyer confidence
- Forces the company to own every decision before work begins

Psychological Effect

A fixed price is not a marketing slogan.

It is proof that the company has already performed the due diligence most installers skip.

The Non-Negotiable Public Face

What the Client Sees

- Fixed price in writing
- Zero dust (99.7% HEPA)
- Salaried master artisans only
- Lifetime workmanship warranty
- Moisture testing + samples on the free estimate

What Protects the Outcome

- Documented protocol on every job
- No subcontractors ever
- Full responsibility retained in-house
- Ability and willingness to refuse jobs that will fail

How to Evaluate Any Installer — Checklist

- ❶ Do they moisture-test on the free estimate and document the readings?
- ❷ Do they require minimum 72-hour acclimation in the actual space?
- ❸ Is the price fixed in writing with no open-ended change-order language?
- ❹ Are the installers salaried employees or day-labour subcontractors?
- ❺ Will they refuse the job if the substrate or conditions are wrong?
- ❻ Is there a true lifetime workmanship warranty in the contract?

Any “no” answer is a red flag.

The EcoWoods Standard vs Market Average

- Market average optimizes for speed and lowest bid
- EcoWoods optimizes for zero callbacks and lifetime performance
- Market average uses subcontractors
- EcoWoods uses only salaried master artisans (many 10+ years)
- Market average treats moisture testing as optional
- EcoWoods treats it as the first non-negotiable gate

Restraint is a competitive advantage:
refuse the job that will fail.

Homeowner Action Plan

- ➊ Request a free in-home estimate that includes moisture testing and samples
- ➋ Insist on a written fixed-price proposal with the full protocol listed
- ➌ Confirm only salaried artisans will perform the work
- ➍ Verify the lifetime workmanship warranty language before signing
- ➎ Keep indoor RH between 35–55% year-round after installation
- ➏ Choose the company that treats the floor the way you want the floor to treat your home for the next 30 years

Key Takeaways

- 1 Hardwood remains the highest-ROI renovation in Toronto when done correctly
- 2 Species and construction must match both aesthetics and the physical reality of the house
- 3 Fixed price + zero dust + salaried artisans + lifetime warranty is the only rational public face
- 4 Demand the full protocol in writing before any deposit is paid
- 5 The company that masters both the forest and the process becomes unavoidable

The floor will declare your competence.

Make sure it only ever declares mastery.

EcoWoods

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